Psychological Safety Check

An anonymous check of how safe it feels to speak up, take risks and admit mistakes, and what to do about it.

Diagnose · Inspired by Amy Edmondson's Research · Anonymous · Not a Validated Survey

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEGEND

- Dot = One anonymous vote
- Yellow Sticky = Observation

1 The Check

ONE DOT PER STATEMENT · VOTE PRIVATELY

	STRONGLY DISAGREE	DISAGREE	NEUTRAL	AGREE	STRONGLY AGREE
1. I can admit a mistake here without it being held against me.		●	●●	●●●	●
2. We raise problems and difficult topics openly.		●●	●●	●●	●
3. Different views and backgrounds are welcomed on this team.			●	●●●●	●●
4. It's safe to try something new here, even if it might fail.		●	●●●	●●	●
5. I can ask anyone on the team for help.				●●●	●●●●
6. People on this team have my back.			●	●●●	●●●
7. My ideas are listened to and used.	●	●●	●●	●●	

2 Run It Safely

SAFETY FIRST, OR THE RESULTS LIE

- [x] Votes are anonymous (board turned away, or an online form)
- [x] Leaders and managers step out while voting
- [x] Results stay with the team unless it chooses to share
- [x] No one is asked to explain their vote
- [x] Talk about patterns, not individuals

Results

STATEMENT	MOSTLY AGREE	MOSTLY DISAGREE	CHANGE
2. Problems	3 of 7	2 of 7	first run
7. Ideas used	2 of 7	3 of 7	first run
5. Asking for help	7 of 7	0 of 7	first run

Re-run every 2–3 months to see the trend.

3 What We Notice

PATTERNS, NOT PEOPLE

- Where are votes lowest? What might explain it?
- What would make it easier to speak up?

Quieter people's ideas get lost in meetings

Problems get raised one-to-one, not in the room

Helping each other is a real strength

4 What Leaders Can Do

MODEL IT

- [ ] Frame work as learning, not just doing
- [x] Admit your own mistakes and doubts
- [ ] Ask genuine questions, then listen
- [x] Thank people for bad news and dissent
- [ ] Respond to failure with curiosity, not blame
- [ ] Make it clear every voice is wanted
- [x] Follow up on what people raise

Priya and Tom will practise the ticked ones first

5 Our Experiments

SMALL CHANGES · CHECK THEM

EXPERIMENT	WHO	CHECK ON
Write silently before discussing ideas	Tom	next retro
Rotate who facilitates refinement	everyone	in 6 weeks
Priya shares one mistake at each review	Priya	end of June

"What would make it easier to say what you really think here?"

"When did someone last speak up, and what happened next?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/better-delivery-toolkit